



Change the message on your login page

If you need to change the message of your virtual console login screen, edit the `/etc/issue` file and write the message that you want to appear at your login screen.

—Bharat Kumar, kmr.bharat@gmail.com



Find a word

To search for a particular stating word in a file, you can use the `find` command in the following way:

```
find / -type f -exec grep -H 'Suyash' {} \;
```

This command will search for the word `Suyash` in the entire file system. If you only want to search in a particular file/folder, you need to specify the path as the first argument. Note that I have provided `/` because I wanted to search the entire file system.

—Suyash Jain, sjain1980@gmail.com



Extract the contents of an RPM

Sometimes we are required to extract the files inside an RPM file instead of installing the RPM. A good example is when we take binaries from one distribution and to use on another distribution, where RPM is not the default package manager. The `rpm2cpio` command comes in handy under these circumstances. For example:

```
$ rpm2cpio coreutils-6.9-2.fc7.i386.rpm | cpio -idv
```

```
./bin/basename
```

```
./bin/cat
```

```
./bin/chgrp
```

```
./bin/chmod
```

```
[-]
```

This command can be used for source RPMs also.

—Yogindar Das Y, yogindar@yahoo.com



Checking memory and I/O

The `vmstat` utility provides interesting information about processes, memory, I/O and

CPU activity. When you run this utility without any arguments, the output looks similar to the following:

```
procs    memory    swap    io    system    cpu
rbw    swpd    free    buff    cache    si    so    bi    bo    in    cs    us    sy    id
000    8    8412    45956    52820    0    0    0    0    104    11    66    0    33
```

Here, the 'procs' fields show the number of processes:

- Waiting for run time (r)
- Blocked (b)
- Swapped out (w)

The 'memory' fields show the KBs of:

- Swap memory
- Free memory
- Buffered memory
- Cached memory

The 'swap' fields show the KBs of memory:

- Swapped in from disk (si)
- Swapped out to disk (so)

The 'io' fields show the number of blocks per second:

- Sent to block devices (bi)
- Received from block devices (bo)

The 'system' field shows the number of:

- Interrupts per second (in)
- Context switches per second (cs)

The 'cpu' field shows the percentage of total CPU time as:

- User time (us)
- System time (sy)
- Idle (id) time

If you want `vmstat` to update information automatically, you can run it as `vmstat nsec`, where `nsec` is the number of seconds you want it to wait before another update.

—Ashish Kumar, Suyash Jain

END

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